Impartial Analysis of Measure U

The Soledad-Mission Recreation District (the District) is an independent special district organized and operating under the Recreation and Park District Law, Public Resources Code section 5780 et. seq., providing recreation programs, aquatic facilities, parks and related services to the residents and property owners within its boundaries. The District has identified needs for ongoing facility maintenance, staffing, administration, recreation programming, and capital reserves to sustain community service, including the Soledad Swimming Pool.

Pursuant to Government Code sections 50077 and 5789.1, and after a public hearing, the District proposed the adoption of a special tax. Pursuant to Article 3.5 (commencing with section 50075) of Chapter 1 of Part 1 of Division 1 of Title 5 of the Government Code, and specifically, section 5789.1, and Public Resources Code section 5789.1, a recreation and park district may levy a special tax.

The special tax will help keep recreation programs affordable, improve accessibility of services; maintain recreation/swim programs for all ages; and support programs like T-ball, soccer, and day camp.

The District placed this measure on the ballot. Upon approval of two-thirds of those voting on this measure, the Special Tax shall commence in 2027 and continue until ended by the voters of the District. The maximum special tax rate shall be $.35 cents per building square foot. For this special tax, unimproved property will be taxed at a rate of zero. The Special Tax is estimated to raise approximately $292,000 in annual local funding for the District. Beginning in 2028, the Board of Directors of the District may increase the maximum special tax rate from the preceding fiscal year by an amount not to exceed the annual Consumer Price Index; but the increase shall not exceed three percent (3%) in any fiscal year. The special tax will be collected by the Monterey County Tax Collector in the same manner and subject to the same penalties as ad valorum property taxes.

As required by law, the District must follow certain accountability provisions to oversee the funds collected and expended, including the establishment of an independent Citizens' Oversight Committee, the annual completion of an Independent Audit, and an annual report detailing the amount of funds collected and expended during the fiscal year and the status of any project or programs.

A "Yes" vote on this measure is a vote in favor of a special tax to fund recreation programs, aquatic services, facility maintenance, staffing, accessibility improvements and long-term capital needs for the Soledad-Mission Recreation District.

A "No" vote on this measure is a vote against a special tax to fund recreation programs, aquatic services, facility maintenance, staffing, accessibility improvements and long-term capital needs for the Soledad-Mission Recreation District.

Received

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Monterey County Elections

Dated: August 14, 2026

Susan Blitch
County Counsel,
County of Monterey